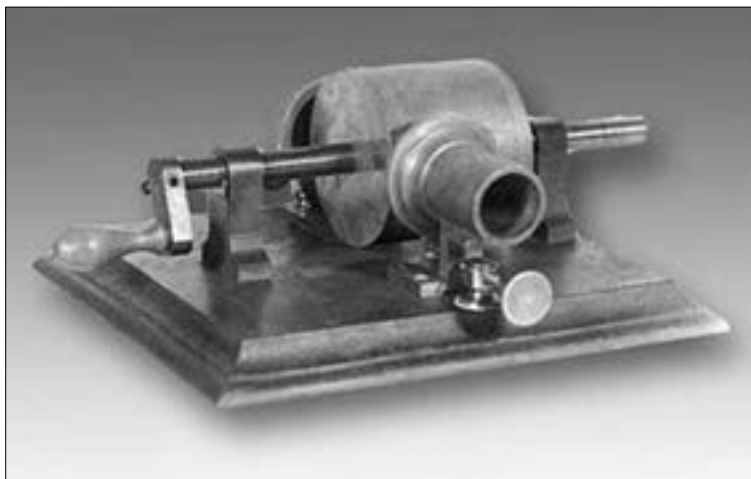




Thomas Edison's Phonograph

and playback. Edison turned the crank and spoke the first recorded words. "Mary had a little lamb, its fleece was white as snow, and everywhere that Mary went, the lamb was sure to go". This was the first recorded sound in the history of audio.

This, however, was just the start of a revolution in the realm of audio recording. Edison made loads of money on this invention as did his competitors. However, the storm had just begun!

Soon, the market was flooded with devices such as the Dictaphone (Columbia) and Ediphone (Edison Company), though, there was another device that we would remember from our childhood that grabbed everybody's attention and made music available to the masses.

The Gramophone

While the phonograph was being developed, a German immigrant by the name of Emile Berliner of Washington, D.C., filed and patented a talking machine that recorded and played back sound in 1888.